serving as a DIG in the CBI when Rajiv Gandhi was assassinated. Kanth, given his experience, was a natural induction into the SIT.

Kanth had a charming personality. He was both ruthless and witty during his interrogation of the Tamil Tigers. He could call their bluff despite his total unfamiliarity with their language. There were times when Murugan and Santhan would just not speak, but Kanth's crafty psychological manipulation induced them to open their mouths. He couldn't care much about being told to be more patient with the accused, who were from the southern side of the Indian subcontinent while he was from the north. He would see the 'criminal' in a suspect and not his 'colour' or 'creed'. He cracked the diabolical backup plan of Sivarasan killing Rajiv Gandhi in New Delhi in case his Tamil Nadu plan failed. With the help of his wide network of informers from the crime world of northern India, Kanth detected and scuttled Sivarasan's efforts to escape through the India–Nepal route. He then alerted the Mumbai underworld and warned them against any possible attempt to help him.

In the SIT, he formed an excellent duo with fellow DIG Radhavinod Raju and cracked the sensational assassination case of Eelam People's Revolutionary Liberation Front (EPRLF) leader K. Padmanabha, which had remained unsolved until the assassination of Rajiv Gandhi. As a result, the SIT was able to draw a parallel between the two assassinations and discovered that both had been conceived by the same person. This was a big breakthrough for the SIT. During the course of the investigation, Kanth took a stand in support of looking into the scope of the larger conspiracy—to see if anyone was involved beyond the LTTE. But he was not encouraged. While fulfilling his obligations at the SIT, Kanth, however, did probe the larger conspiracy theory and made substantial progress, which later became useful for the separate inquiry commissions set up to look into the 'security lapse' and the 'the larger conspiracy' during Rajiv's assassination.

RADHAVINOD RAJU (42): DIG, CBI